Justice delayed, denied

On 11 January 2018, the Supreme Court constituted a three-member special investigation team (SIT) under former Delhi High Court judge, Justice S.N. Dhingra. The other two members were Abhishek Dular, a serving IPS officer of the 2006 batch from the Himachal Pradesh cadre, and Rajdeep Singh, a former IGP rank officer of the BSF. The purpose of the SIT was to examine the 199 cases that another SIT (appointed in February 2015 by the government and headed by IPS officer Pramod Asthana) had recommended for closure, along with forty-two other cases that a Supreme Court-appointed supervisory committee of two former judges had examined.

As Rajdeep Singh expressed his inability to join the SIT, the Supreme Court, in November 2018, allowed the remaining two to carry out the investigation. In January 2019, the court gave the SIT three months to file its report. The report was finalized and submitted to the Union law ministry by the end of April 2019. Though Justice Dhingra had been asking the law ministry officials for the past eight months to seek a date from the court so that the SIT's work could be brought to a closure, for reasons best known to the law ministry, it submitted his report to the Supreme Court in a sealed cover only in November 2019. [8]

The SIT report was finally taken up by the Supreme Court on 15 January 2020. The Solicitor General informed the Supreme Court that the Central government had accepted the recommendations of this Committee and would take action as per its recommendations.

In its report, the Dhingra Committee took special note of the Tughlakabad railway station incident. It observed that the Tughlakabad railway station massacre saw police recover seventy-one bodies, twenty-nine of which remained unidentified. The police said the rioters were very many in number, hence they could not prevent the massacre. The police did not identify a single rioter later.

Some of the other observations made by Justice Dhingra Committee are as follows: